Dibbler



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Dibbler; Manual dibbler

What it is used for

To make planting holes at consistent spacing and depth using a manual dibbler. To place seeds or seedlings accurately while reducing soil disturbance.

Main parts

- Pointed planting tip
- Shaft or body
- Handle or grip
- Depth marker, if fitted

Before you start

1. Select a dibbler suitable for the crop and soil condition.
2. Inspect the tip, shaft, and handle for cracks or looseness.
3. Prepare the bed and remove large stones or debris.
4. Check the required planting spacing and depth.
5. Wear suitable gloves and footwear.

How to use

1. Mark the planting positions according to the crop spacing plan.
2. Hold the dibbler securely by its handle.
3. Place the tip at the first marked position.
4. Press into the soil to the required depth using controlled force.
5. Withdraw the dibbler vertically to leave a neat hole.
6. Repeat at the remaining marked positions.
7. Place the seed or seedling and cover with soil as required.
8. Clean the tool after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep hands and feet clear of the pointed tip.
- Do not force the tool into soil containing hidden hard objects.
- Maintain stable footing while pressing into the ground.
- Do not use a cracked or loose-handled dibbler.

Care & storage

- Remove soil from the tip and shaft after use.
- Dry metal parts to reduce rust.
- Inspect the handle and tip regularly.
- Store in a dry, secure location.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Making holes at inconsistent depths.
- Ignoring the crop's spacing requirements.
- Tilting the dibbler and widening the hole unnecessarily.
- Using excessive force in unsuitable soil.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar